

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Nail Technician English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Nail technicians, manicurists, pedicurists, and nail-salon reception staff.

All scenarios, prices, products, records, and incidents are fictional language practice. This is not instruction in nail preparation, application, removal, disinfection, chemical handling, or medical assessment. Qualified staff must determine service suitability and follow current product instructions and local requirements. Do not diagnose nail or skin conditions from these exercises.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

Open this course on English Ladder

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Clarifying the service and the intended length

Distinguish a client's visual preference from a booking name.

02 Comparing shape and practical length

Distinguish shape from length when discussing samples.

03 Explaining color, coverage, and finish

Distinguish shine from coverage without confusing them with product type.

04 Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote

Negotiate the number of decorated nails using the supplied prices.

05 Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns

Acknowledge an appearance goal while keeping an unassessed concern explicit.

06 Giving a clear station-readiness update

Separate visual tidiness from confirmed service readiness.

07 Handling a chip or design concern

Acknowledge a recorded design error and offer a bounded review.

08 Scheduling follow-up and handing over exact requests

Distinguish a requested appointment from confirmed service details.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying the service and the intended length

Distinguish a client's visual preference from a booking name.

SITUATION

A client booked an overlay but calls it a full set and points to a long reference image. They actually want to keep their current short length. No work has begun. Clarify length and explain why the image does not automatically mean extensions.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

manicure - A cosmetic service for fingernails and hands, with the included elements set by the salon menu.

pedicure - A cosmetic service for toenails and feet, not medical treatment of foot conditions.

overlay - An enhancement product applied over the natural nail without deliberately adding length.

extension - An artificial addition that lengthens the nail beyond its natural length.

Useful word combinations

retain the natural length: keep the client's current nail length

clarify the booked service: check which service the appointment reserves

add extra length: make the finished nail longer than the natural nail

describe the desired result: explain the appearance wanted before choosing a service

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Check length before interpreting a service label

3. Notice the language

Terms such as full set can be used loosely. Ask about added length explicitly rather than treating a photograph as a complete instruction.

Do you want added length or ___?

Which part of the photo do you mean?

Your booking says ___; let's confirm ___.

Compare this wording: A full set means those long nails.

Clearer: Are you choosing the color, the added length, or both?

The question lets the client separate independent choices.

4. Check the language

1. Client: What is an enhancement covering my existing natural nails without adding length called?

Technician: An ____.

A. embellishment

B. overlay

C. extension

D. infill

2. Client: I like the picture, but only its color.

Technician: Could you confirm ____?

A. whether you want to keep your length

B. whether do you want to keep your length

C. whether you wants to keep your length

D. whether want you to keep your length

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Long reference, short request

A nail technician clarifies an overlay booking.

01 • Technician: Your booking says overlay, but your photograph shows added length. Which part do you want?

02 • Client: Only the pink color. I need to keep my nails short for work.

03 • Technician: Then let's separate the color from the extra length shown in the reference picture.

04 • Client: I called it a full set on the phone. Was that the wrong expression?

05 • Technician: People use that phrase differently. Asking about actual length gives us a clearer shared request.

06 • Client: So an overlay doesn't mean you automatically make the nails as long as the photograph?

07 • Technician: That's right: it goes over the natural nail without deliberately adding length to it.

08 • Client: That's what I meant. I don't want extensions, even if they appear in the photograph.

09 • Technician: I'll note pink color requested, existing short length retained, and no extensions in today's request.

10 • Client: Good. Please show me the color sample separately so the long image doesn't confuse us.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Hands or feet on the booking?

Reception checks an unclear online service selection.

01 • Receptionist: Your booking lists a manicure, but your message mentions choosing a color for your toes.

02 • Client: I may have selected the wrong service. I wanted a pedicure for my feet.

03 • Receptionist: Thank you for checking. A manicure is for hands; a pedicure concerns feet and toenails.

04 • Client: Could you simply change the word, or does the appointment need a different time?

05 • Receptionist: I need to check the appropriate appointment space before confirming a different service.

06 • Client: I can come later if necessary. I don't need my hands done this week.

07 • Receptionist: There is a pedicure slot at three. That replaces the manicure rather than adding both.

08 • Client: Three works. Could the confirmation say pedicure so I can check the change?

09 • Receptionist: Yes, I've changed the booking to a pedicure at three and removed the manicure.

10 • Client: The new message matches what I wanted. I'll choose the toe color when I arrive.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

One longer nail does not define the whole request

A client brings a reference showing mixed nail lengths.

01 • Technician: Tell me which length you want overall, rather than relying only on this reference photograph.

02 • Client: Most of the nails look short, but the middle one looks longer than mine.

03 • Technician: Are you requesting that extra length too, or just asking about the difference in the picture?

04 • Client: I'm asking about the difference. I want all of mine at my present short length.

05 • Technician: Then we won't treat the longer pictured nail as a request for an extension.

06 • Client: Could I still discuss the same color and simple pattern on my shorter nails?

07 • Technician: Yes, we can discuss their appearance separately from length, then assess the actual service request.

08 • Client: I don't want the booking changed to extensions just because I showed this image.

09 • Technician: Understood. Your request stays short length, with the color and pattern still to be chosen.

10 • Client: That's accurate. Let's look at shorter samples before I decide which pattern I prefer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying the service and the intended length

A client booked an overlay but calls it a full set and points to a long reference image. They actually want to keep their current short length. No work has begun. Clarify length and explain why the image does not automatically mean extensions.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: want the pictured pink color but no additional length; used full set without a precise meaning.

Second round: The client says overlay and extension sound interchangeable. Explain the length distinction plainly.

Scenario 2 | A gift booking names the wrong service

A friend booked a pedicure for a recipient who wants a manicure. A hand-service appointment is available tomorrow at eleven; today's pedicure slot cannot be converted.

Role A: Receptionist: clarify hands versus feet and offer the stated alternative.

Role B: Client: prefer tomorrow's manicure and want the friend informed without discussing personal details.

Possible opening: The gift says pedicure, but I meant my hands.

Success checks

- Identify the requested service plainly.
- Do not silently add another service.
- Confirm tomorrow's manicure and removal of today's booking.

Add a complication: The client asks whether both services can fit into the original slot.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Comparing shape and practical length

Distinguish shape from length when discussing samples.

SITUATION

A client likes a long almond sample but needs a short result for keyboard work. A short squoval sample is also available. Compare the sample silhouettes and lengths without promising that either shape will prevent breakage or discomfort.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

free edge - The part of a natural nail that extends beyond the fingertip.

squoval - A nail outline combining a relatively square end with softened corners.

almond shape - A nail outline that narrows toward a softly pointed, almond-like tip.

swatch - A sample showing a nail color or finish for comparison.

Useful word combinations

soften the corners: describe a less sharply squared outline

compare the silhouettes: look at the outer shapes side by side

keep a practical length: choose a length suited to the client's stated activities

point to the free edge: identify the part extending beyond the fingertip

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Compare like-for-like features

3. Notice the language

Two samples can differ on more than one dimension. Name the outline and length separately so a preference for one does not silently select the other.

This outline is ___, whereas that one is ___.

The lengths differ as well as ___.

Which feature matters most for ___?

Compare this wording: Almond is always better.

Clearer: This almond sample is longer and more tapered; the squoval sample is shorter with softer corners.

The explanation names observable differences without a universal ranking.

4. Check the language

1. Client: Which outline has a flatter end and softened corners?

Technician: This ___ sample.

A. squoval

B. almond-shaped

C. round

D. pointed

2. Client: What do you call only the part extending beyond my fingertip?

Technician: The ___.

A. nail bed

B. cuticle

C. nail plate

D. free edge

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A shorter sample changes the comparison

A client compares almond and squoval samples.

01 • Technician: This almond sample is longer than the squoval one. Which feature catches your attention?

02 • Client: The narrow tip looks elegant, but I type all day and want a short result.

03 • Technician: Then we need to compare length separately from the shape of the tip.

04 • Client: I thought choosing almond meant choosing exactly the length shown on the display.

05 • Technician: The display is a reference, not your final specification. Your preferred length still matters.

06 • Client: What makes the squoval sample different from the almond shape, apart from the length?

07 • Technician: Its end is flatter, with softened corners, whereas the almond outline narrows toward the tip.

08 • Client: I like the flatter end and softer corners. Let's use the shorter sample.

09 • Technician: Certainly. We'll use that reference while assessing your actual request and confirming the length.

10 • Client: That looks closer. Can you show me the length before we start?

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Even length or the longest nail?

A technician checks what a client means by matching lengths.

01 • Technician: When you say make them match, do you mean similar visible length or identical decoration?

02 • Client: Similar length. One nail is much longer, and I don't want the others extended to match it.

03 • Technician: Then retaining that longest nail isn't your priority. Is a shorter overall appearance acceptable?

04 • Client: Yes, but please show me the intended length before assuming how short I mean.

05 • Technician: We can use the free edge as a visible reference during the consultation.

06 • Client: That's the part beyond my fingertip, correct? I haven't heard that term before.

07 • Technician: Correct. Point to the amount you want to keep so we can discuss it clearly.

08 • Client: About this much. I want the overall result short without confusing short with no visible edge.

09 • Technician: I understand the reference point. We'll confirm the intended outline as a separate choice.

10 • Client: Good. Similar short length is the goal, with the exact shape still to discuss.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The color swatch is on a long tip

A client worries that choosing a swatch selects its length.

01 • Technician: You chose this blue swatch. Is it the shade you like or its long pointed outline?

02 • Client: Just the shade. I was worried you would copy the plastic tip's length too.

03 • Technician: The swatch lets us compare color; its display shape doesn't determine your service request.

04 • Client: That's reassuring. I'd like the blue with the short rounded outline we discussed earlier.

05 • Technician: I'll keep those choices separate: blue shade and short rounded outline, without adding length.

06 • Client: Could I see the blue next to the gray sample before making the color final?

07 • Technician: Of course. What difference matters to you when you compare them in this light?

08 • Client: The gray looks softer. I may prefer it for the meeting I have tomorrow.

09 • Technician: Then take a moment to compare. The shape decision stays the same whichever shade you select.

10 • Client: I'll choose the gray. My earlier blue choice wasn't meant to change the length.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Comparing shape and practical length

A client likes a long almond sample but needs a short result for keyboard work. A short squoval sample is also available. Compare the sample silhouettes and lengths without promising that either shape will prevent breakage or discomfort.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: like the almond outline but do not want the sample's long length.

Second round: The client assumes selecting the short sample guarantees it will never snag. Avoid an unsupported promise.

Scenario 2 | A photographed angle hides the length

A client brings a side-angle image and asks for 'the same short shape.' A front-view reference is available, showing a longer pointed tip. The client wants a short rounded outline.

Role A: Technician: compare views and confirm the requested outline.

Role B: Client: reject the long tip revealed in the front view.

Possible opening: It looked much shorter from the side in this photograph.

Success checks

- Identify which pictured feature is rejected.
- Separate camera angle from actual length.
- Restate the short rounded request.

Add a complication: The client keeps saying 'the same' after rejecting one feature.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Explaining color, coverage, and finish

Distinguish shine from coverage without confusing them with product type.

SITUATION

A client requests matte pink but selects a sheer glossy swatch. They want a low-shine appearance with the nail line still visible. The booking does not specify lacquer or gel polish. Explain finish versus coverage and leave product selection open.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

lacquer - Conventional nail polish that forms a colored coating as it dries.

gel polish - A nail coating designed to cure under a compatible lamp according to its product system.

sheer - Allowing some of the underlying nail to remain visible through the color.

matte - Having a low-shine appearance rather than a glossy surface.

Useful word combinations

choose a finish: select the intended shiny or low-shine appearance

compare the coverage: discuss how much of the nail remains visible

check the product label: identify the exact product rather than guess from its color

describe a sheer shade: explain that the underlying nail remains partly visible

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Explain two different appearance choices

3. Notice the language

A color name does not specify coverage, finish, or product system. Explain each choice using the client's actual description.

Matte describes ___; sheer describes ___.

You can prefer ___ without requesting ___.

The product choice is still ___.

Compare this wording: Sheer and matte are the same.

Clearer: Sheer concerns visibility through the color; matte concerns shine.

The explanation separates two independent properties.

4. Check the language

1. Client: I want the natural nail visible through the pink.

Technician: You want a ___ shade.

A. opaque

B. metallic

C. matte

D. sheer

2. Client: I mean less shine, not less color or a different shape.

Technician: Then you're asking about the ___.

A. silhouette

B. added length

C. finish

D. coverage

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Sheer and matte answer different questions

A technician clarifies a pink color request.

01 • Technician: You asked for matte pink, but chose a glossy sheer sample. What matters most?

02 • Client: I want the nail line to show, with less shine than this display tip.

03 • Technician: Then sheer describes the coverage you like, and matte describes the low-shine finish.

04 • Client: I thought sheer meant not shiny. Thanks for separating those words for me.

05 • Technician: The sample shows your preferred coverage, but doesn't display both of your requested features.

06 • Client: Does choosing that pink also mean I'm choosing gel polish for today's appointment?

07 • Technician: Not automatically. Color, finish, and product choice are separate parts of our consultation.

08 • Client: Then please leave the product choice open while we compare the available descriptions.

09 • Technician: Certainly. Your current request is sheer pink with low shine, not added opacity.

10 • Client: That's accurate. I'd like to see an appropriate sample before agreeing to the final choice.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A color name does not identify a product

A client brings an old receipt showing only a shade name.

01 • Technician: The receipt says Rose Garden, but doesn't identify whether the previous service used gel polish.

02 • Client: I assumed the color name would tell you. It looked like an ordinary pink.

03 • Technician: The same shade name can appear on different products, so I shouldn't infer the system.

04 • Client: Could you look at the old appointment record instead of guessing from the photograph?

05 • Technician: Yes. We can check whether the product was recorded and keep any missing detail explicit.

06 • Client: Would the fact that it stayed shiny tell you which product it definitely was?

07 • Technician: No. Appearance alone doesn't establish the exact product used in that previous service.

08 • Client: I can ask the original salon for details if our record doesn't show them.

09 • Technician: That would help. For now I'll describe the product as unidentified, not as confirmed lacquer.

10 • Client: Please do. I'd rather have an accurate question than a confident answer based on the name.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Opaque was not the requested effect

A client compares two pink samples at reception.

01 • Technician: Both samples are pink, but this one hides the nail line more completely.

02 • Client: Then I prefer the other one. I don't want the whole nail covered by solid-looking color.

03 • Technician: You're describing a sheer effect rather than the opaque appearance of the first sample.

04 • Client: Exactly. The word pink alone didn't explain what I had in mind originally.

05 • Technician: Would you like to compare them against a neutral background before deciding today?

06 • Client: Yes, because the dark display stand makes the lighter one difficult for me to judge.

07 • Technician: Here they are together. We can discuss the difference without assuming a precise result on your nails.

08 • Client: I'll choose this more transparent-looking pink. Please keep that sample beside the other finish options.

09 • Technician: I'll record that coverage preference and keep the finish choice separate for our next question.

10 • Client: Good. I still want to discuss shine, but the coverage question is now settled.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Explaining color, coverage, and finish

A client requests matte pink but selects a sheer glossy swatch. They want a low-shine appearance with the nail line still visible. The booking does not specify lacquer or gel polish. Explain finish versus coverage and leave product selection open.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: want sheer pink and low shine; have not chosen lacquer or gel polish.

Second round: The client thinks a glossy swatch proves a matte version will be identical apart from shine. Offer comparison without guaranteeing an exact match.

Scenario 2 | The shade code stays the same but the finish changes

A client wants the same blue shade code, B12, as last visit but a matte rather than glossy appearance. No matching matte sample has been reviewed.

Role A: Technician: confirm B12 as the retained blue shade preference and distinguish it from the changed finish.

Role B: Client: want blue B12 with less shine; do not want a different blue chosen silently.

Possible opening: Can I keep blue B12 but make it less shiny?

Success checks

- Confirm the retained blue shade code B12.
- Name the changed finish.
- Avoid guaranteeing identical appearance across lighting conditions.

Add a complication: The client assumes the same code guarantees an identical appearance under every light.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote

Negotiate the number of decorated nails using the supplied prices.

SITUATION

A fictional base service costs \$30. Simple line art is \$5 per nail, with no other charges in this exercise. The client wants four decorated nails but has a \$40 limit. Offer two decorated nails for \$40 or the base service alone for \$30.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

accent nail - A nail given a different decorative design to stand out from the others.

nail art - Decorative patterns or images created on nails.

embellishment - A decorative addition, such as a small ornament, included in a nail design.

service quote - A stated price for a specified nail service before the client agrees to it.

Useful word combinations

price per nail: state a charge for each decorated nail

simplify the design: reduce its decorative detail

confirm the design count: agree how many nails receive the pattern

stay within the budget: choose work that fits the stated spending limit

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Offer a design tradeoff with a clear total

3. Notice the language

State whether a charge applies per nail, per hand, or to the whole design. Confirm the selected nails as well as the total.

The charge is ___ per nail.

With ___ accent nails, the total is ___.

Which ___ nails would you choose?

Compare this wording: The design is five dollars.

Clearer: The line art is five dollars per nail; two decorated nails add ten dollars.

The unit of price prevents a misleading total.

4. Check the language

1. Client: Does five dollars cover both hands?

Technician: No, it's five dollars ____.

A. for all ten nails

B. for both hands

C. per decorated nail

D. per appointment

2. Client: Four decorated nails would exceed my forty-dollar limit. What can we agree on?

Technician: We can stay within forty ____.

A. unless we leave out the extra two designs

B. provided that we limit the line art to two nails

C. even if we include all four decorated nails

D. because the design is charged once per hand

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Four designs exceed the stated limit

A client has a forty-dollar budget. Fictional final prices are thirty for the base service and five per line-art nail, with no other charges.

01 • Technician: The base service is thirty dollars, and this line art costs five per nail.

02 • Client: I wanted four decorated nails, but my budget for the whole appointment is forty.

03 • Technician: Four would make fifty. Two accent nails would bring the complete total to forty.

04 • Client: Could we put the design on one nail on each hand instead of four?

05 • Technician: Yes. Which two nails do you want marked in the agreed design request?

06 • Client: The ring finger on each hand, please. All the others can have the plain color.

07 • Technician: The base and those two line-art nails come to forty dollars altogether for today's service.

08 • Client: Does that include the little stones in the photograph, or just the painted lines?

09 • Technician: Just the lines. The stones aren't included in this quote or your current design.

10 • Client: Leave the stones out, then. Two line-art accent nails and a forty-dollar total work.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The design has a front and a back

A technician checks the orientation of lettering in a design.

01 • Technician: For the lettering, which direction should it face when you look down at your hands?

02 • Client: I hadn't thought about that. I want to read it myself while my hands rest flat.

03 • Technician: That differs from lettering oriented toward someone looking at your fingertips from across a table.

04 • Client: Then please use the direction for me, not the direction in the social-media picture.

05 • Technician: Let's check this sample orientation before including it in the design agreement today.

06 • Client: This sample is right. Could both hands follow the same reading direction rather than mirror each other?

07 • Technician: We can record that request clearly, then confirm the final design and price together.

08 • Client: One letter on each ring-finger nail, one per hand, not the whole word.

09 • Technician: Thank you. I'll count two lettered nails and keep the other nails plain.

10 • Client: That description matches my intention. Please quote those two letters rather than the photographed full word.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An embellishment was only an idea

A client clarifies that a design question was not a purchase decision.

01 • Technician: You asked about adding an embellishment. Would you like a price before deciding whether to include it?

02 • Client: Yes. I was asking how it would look, not agreeing to pay for it yet.

03 • Technician: Understood. Our current quote is for plain color only, with no decorative additions.

04 • Client: Could you explain whether the displayed extra price is for one nail or the full set?

05 • Technician: This label is per decorated nail. The number chosen changes the total for the appointment.

06 • Client: Then I need a complete quote before choosing. I may decide the plain version is enough.

07 • Technician: Certainly. For two embellished nails, the extra would be twelve dollars above your existing quote.

08 • Client: That's more than I planned. I'll keep the plain color and skip the embellishments today.

09 • Technician: I'll retain the original quote and remove the proposed additions from our discussion summary.

10 • Client: Thank you. Looking at options shouldn't leave the impression that I've already ordered them.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote

A fictional base service costs \$30. Simple line art is \$5 per nail, with no other charges in this exercise. The client wants four decorated nails but has a \$40 limit. Offer two decorated nails for \$40 or the base service alone for \$30.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: want four decorated nails but cannot exceed forty dollars; can accept two.

Second round: The client requests an embellishment not included in the line-art quote. Keep its price unconfirmed.

Scenario 2 | A design is too detailed for the reserved time

A forty-minute appointment covers plain color. The detailed reference design needs a separate sixty-minute booking, available Friday at two. A simple one-line design fits today's stated slot and adds \$5.

Role A: Technician: offer today's simple option or Friday's longer appointment.

Role B: Client: prefer the detailed design and can attend Friday.

Possible opening: Can we add everything in this photograph to today's booking?

Success checks

- Separate the two design scopes.
- Use the stated appointment lengths and price limit accurately.
- Confirm Friday for the detailed design with its quote still to be discussed.

Add a complication: The client asks for the full design at the simple design's extra price.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns

Acknowledge an appearance goal while keeping an unassessed concern explicit.

SITUATION

Before any service starts, a client reports unexplained tenderness beside one nail and asks you to cover it with product for an event. Pause that service request and refer the health concern to an appropriate healthcare professional without diagnosing or suggesting treatment. Explain that the salon must separately decide whether the cosmetic service is suitable; referral does not promise service approval.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

nail plate - The hard, visible part of the natural nail.

cuticle - The thin layer of nonliving tissue attached to the nail plate near its base; not the whole surrounding skin.

lifting - Separation of an applied nail enhancement or coating from the natural nail.

tenderness - Soreness or discomfort reported when an area is touched or pressed.

Useful word combinations

describe the location: identify where a concern is felt or seen

pause on request: stop the activity when the client asks

avoid diagnosing the cause: do not label an unassessed condition as a medical finding

refer a health concern: direct a medical question to an appropriate healthcare professional

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

State a service boundary without diagnosing

3. Notice the language

Use the client's own symptom words. Distinguish a reported feeling, an observed change, and an unknown cause. Refer the health concern to an appropriate healthcare professional; salon staff separately decide whether the cosmetic service is suitable without diagnosing the cause.

You've reported ____; the cause is unknown.

I can't confirm that ____ is appropriate.

Let's pause the request while ____.

Compare this wording: It's probably just normal.

Clearer: You've reported tenderness; I can't identify its cause from this conversation.

The revised wording neither minimizes nor invents a diagnosis.

4. Check the language

1. Client: Can you tell why this feels sore before anyone has examined it?

Technician: The cause is ____.

A. natural regrowth

B. unassessed

C. cosmetic wear

D. product lifting

2. Client: The enhancement is separating from my natural nail, not just losing a tiny surface piece.

Technician: That description suggests ____.

A. lifting

B. chipping

C. regrowth

D. sheer coverage

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An event does not answer a suitability question

A client raises tenderness before a nail service.

01 • Technician: You mentioned tenderness beside this nail. Has a healthcare professional assessed it before today's appointment?

02 • Client: No, but I have an event tonight. Could you just cover it so it looks finished?

03 • Technician: I understand the appearance goal, but I can't confirm that covering it is appropriate.

04 • Client: It's only one area. Does that mean you know what's causing the soreness?

05 • Technician: No. A healthcare professional should assess that health concern; I can't diagnose its cause.

06 • Client: Then please don't put a diagnosis in the note. I don't have one.

07 • Technician: I'll record your words and pause this request. The salon still needs to assess service suitability.

08 • Client: Could you explain that to reception without saying I've cancelled every future appointment?

09 • Technician: Yes. A health referral doesn't approve a service or change your future bookings.

10 • Client: Thank you. I want the issue taken seriously without the record saying more than we know.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The client names the wrong area

A technician helps a client locate a reported concern.

01 • Technician: When you say the whole cuticle hurts, could you point to the exact area you mean?

02 • Client: I mean the skin beside the nail, not the hard part on top.

03 • Technician: Thank you. The hard visible part is the nail plate; your concern is beside it.

04 • Client: I don't know the correct term for that skin. I just know it feels sore.

05 • Technician: Your description is enough to report the concern accurately without choosing a diagnosis.

06 • Client: Does asking you about it mean you can tell me what treatment it needs?

07 • Technician: No. A medical question needs an appropriate healthcare professional, not a cosmetic description alone.

08 • Client: Please keep today's service paused while I decide how to get that concern assessed.

09 • Technician: Of course. I'll say you reported soreness beside the nail before any service started.

10 • Client: That's accurate. I appreciate not having my uncertain terminology turned into a medical conclusion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A lifting report without a cause

A client asks about separation at the edge of a coating.

01 • Technician: You said the coating seems raised at an edge. Which nail are you referring to?

02 • Client: The right index finger. I noticed it this morning, but I don't know why it happened.

03 • Technician: That may describe lifting, meaning separation from the natural nail; it doesn't tell us the cause.

04 • Client: Could the photograph I sent prove it was caused by the last appointment here?

05 • Technician: The photograph can show your concern, but it doesn't establish the cause by itself.

06 • Client: I see. I want a review, not a claim recorded as though we've proved it.

07 • Technician: I'll arrange that and note when you first noticed the change on that nail.

08 • Client: Should I assume a repair is booked just because I sent the photograph this morning?

09 • Technician: No. The review is the agreed next step; the suitable response hasn't been determined.

10 • Client: Then please confirm the review time separately and keep the possible repair unconfirmed for now.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns

Before any service starts, a client reports unexplained tenderness beside one nail and asks you to cover it with product for an event. Pause that service request and refer the health concern to an appropriate healthcare professional without diagnosing or suggesting treatment. Explain that the salon must separately decide whether the cosmetic service is suitable; referral does not promise service approval.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: feel tenderness beside one nail; want it covered for an event and have no diagnosis.

Second round: The client says a friend called it harmless. Acknowledge the report without adopting that conclusion.

Scenario 2 | A strong smell prompts a pause

During a consultation, a client reports that a product odor bothers them and asks to stop. The technician has not applied product. The manager can discuss the concern immediately.

Role A: Technician: pause the service discussion and communicate the reported concern.

Role B: Client: want to move away from the station and talk to the manager, not receive a diagnosis.

Possible opening: Could we stop? That smell is bothering me.

Success checks

- Use the client's words rather than an invented diagnosis.
- Confirm that application has not begun.
- Arrange the stated manager discussion while keeping the service paused.

Add a complication: A colleague calls the concern an allergy without any assessment.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Giving a clear station-readiness update

Separate visual tidiness from confirmed service readiness.

SITUATION

Station three is tidy, but its required readiness checks are incomplete. Station two has been confirmed ready by the responsible technician. A client is waiting. Offer station two without calling station three ready or providing disinfection instructions.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

reusable implement - A nail-service tool intended for repeated use subject to required cleaning and disinfection.

single-use item - A service item intended for one use rather than reuse on another client.

disinfection - A specified process to reduce or eliminate relevant microorganisms on suitable objects; not the same as tidying.

contact time - The period a disinfectant must remain in contact as specified by its label and applicable procedure.

Useful word combinations

confirm station readiness: check whether the required preparation is complete

separate used items: distinguish used items from those prepared for a service

check the readiness record: consult the salon's recorded preparation status

give a waiting-time update: tell a client what is complete and what remains uncertain

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Describe the stage, not an impression

3. Notice the language

Give a concise status and a verified alternative. Do not turn this language exercise into instructions for disinfectant use or tool preparation.

___ is tidy; ___ remains incomplete.

___ has been confirmed ready.

I don't yet have a reliable estimate for ___.

Compare this wording: That station looks ready.

Clearer: The station is tidy, but the required readiness checks are incomplete.

The update avoids treating appearance as confirmation.

4. Check the language

1. Client: Is station three ready now?

Technician: Its readiness checks are ____.

A. incomplete

B. completed

C. repeated

D. waived

2. Colleague: Does contact time mean how long we chatted with the client?

Technician: No, here it concerns the ____.

A. appointment reminder time

B. client's arrival time

C. length of the consultation

D. disinfectant's specified contact period

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Tidy does not mean ready

A technician gives a waiting client a station update.

01 • Technician: Station three is tidy, but its required readiness checks haven't been completed yet.

02 • Client: It looks empty and clean from here. Is that different from being ready for my appointment?

03 • Technician: Yes. Appearance alone doesn't confirm those checks. Station two has been confirmed ready.

04 • Client: I'd prefer the window station, but I don't want to wait without an estimate.

05 • Technician: I don't have a reliable wait for station three; I can offer station two now.

06 • Client: Would changing stations also change the technician or the service we already agreed on?

07 • Technician: No. The same technician and agreed service would use the confirmed space at station two.

08 • Client: Then I'll take that option. Please don't rush the other station just for my preference.

09 • Technician: Thank you. I'll direct you to station two and leave station three's status unchanged.

10 • Client: That works. Knowing which space is actually ready matters more than the window today.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A colleague needs the status, not a procedure

Two technicians clarify an incomplete station note.

01 • Technician: The station note says cleared, but reception is interpreting that word as ready for the next client.

02 • Lead technician: Cleared means used items were removed; it doesn't record completion of all the required preparation.

03 • Technician: Then I'll correct reception's understanding. Which station can they offer the waiting client right now?

04 • Lead technician: Station one is confirmed ready. Station four is still awaiting its readiness check this afternoon.

05 • Technician: I'll give them that distinction without estimating how long the remaining check will take.

06 • Lead technician: Please also avoid saying disinfection is finished merely because the work surface looks tidy.

07 • Technician: Please let reception know when station four is ready. They've got another client arriving at three.

08 • Lead technician: I will. We're still checking the disinfection record, including the required contact time for these implements.

09 • Technician: I'll send the waiting client to station one and keep station four marked unavailable.

10 • Lead technician: Thanks. I'll contact reception directly once we've finished the remaining checks at four.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A label question deserves a specific answer

A client asks about a packaged item before a service.

01 • Client: Is this item reused after each customer, or is it meant for one use?

02 • Technician: The package identifies this particular item as single-use. Reusable implements are a different category.

03 • Client: I saw several similar-looking items nearby, so I wasn't sure whether appearance told me anything.

04 • Technician: Similar appearance doesn't establish the item's category or preparation status. We check the actual item.

05 • Client: Could you explain that distinction without giving me a long technical description of the chemicals?

06 • Technician: Certainly. Single-use means intended for one use; reusable means it has preparation requirements before reuse.

07 • Client: So reusable doesn't mean it is automatically ready just because it can be used again?

08 • Technician: Correct. Its permitted reuse and its present readiness are different questions to check.

09 • Client: Thanks, I wanted to check before we started. I'd rather ask now than worry during the appointment.

10 • Technician: Of course. This item is single-use, and I'll confirm the other items are ready before we begin.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Giving a clear station-readiness update

Station three is tidy, but its required readiness checks are incomplete. Station two has been confirmed ready by the responsible technician. A client is waiting. Offer station two without calling station three ready or providing disinfection instructions.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: would prefer station three but can accept station two if the reason is clear.

Second round: The client asks for a specific waiting time nobody has confirmed. Offer the verified alternative without inventing minutes.

Scenario 2 | A station change needs a new message

Reception told a client station five was available, but the lead has now marked it unavailable pending a check. Station one is ready, and the client's usual technician can work there.

Role A: Technician: correct the earlier station message with no invented cause.

Role B: Client: prefer the same technician and accept station one.

Possible opening: Reception said I could sit at five. Has that changed?

Success checks

- State the changed status.
- Offer the confirmed station and same technician.
- Avoid speculating about the reason for the check.

Add a complication: The client assumes a station change means the appointment is cancelled.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Handling a chip or design concern

Acknowledge a recorded design error and offer a bounded review.

SITUATION

A client requested line art facing them, but the finished lettering faces away. The service record confirms the client's original direction. A review is available today at four with no review fee. Do not promise a particular correction before assessment.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

chip - A small piece missing from the edge or surface of a nail coating.

snag - An uneven edge that catches on clothing or another surface.

repair appointment - A visit reserved to assess and, when suitable and agreed, correct a specific nail-service problem.

service record - The salon's factual record of the service, selected products, and relevant client discussion.

Useful word combinations

report a chipped edge: describe the missing coating and its location

review the service record: check what was actually recorded at the earlier visit

acknowledge a design mismatch: recognize that the result differs from the discussed design

confirm review terms: explain any stated review fee and what the appointment covers

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Repair a specific mismatch

3. Notice the language

Separate the confirmed mismatch from the remedy, which may still require assessment and agreement.

The note says ____; the result shows ____.

I'm sorry we missed ____.

The review covers ____; it doesn't yet confirm ____.

Compare this wording: You should have checked it sooner.

Clearer: The direction differs from the recorded request; let's arrange a review.

The response addresses the actual mismatch without shifting blame.

4. Check the language

1. Client: The letters face away, but my record says they should face me.

Technician: The concern is the design's ____.

A. opacity

B. symmetry

C. color intensity

D. orientation

2. Client: Is the four o'clock review free?

Receptionist: Yes, there is no ____ for the review itself.

A. record

B. appointment

C. fee

D. availability

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The letters face the wrong way

A technician acknowledges a recorded design mismatch.

01 • Technician: The service record says the letters should face you. I can see your concern about their direction.

02 • Client: They face away when my hands are in the position we discussed before starting.

03 • Technician: That doesn't match the recorded request. I'm sorry we missed that specific detail.

04 • Client: Could we talk about what can be done, rather than pretend it's what I asked for?

05 • Technician: Yes. A review is available today at four, with no fee for that discussion.

06 • Client: Does agreeing to the review mean I'm already agreeing to a whole new service?

07 • Technician: No. We'll assess the concern and discuss any proposed correction before you decide.

08 • Client: Please make clear that my complaint concerns the direction, not the chosen blue color.

09 • Technician: I will. The note will identify the orientation mismatch and retain the agreed color preference.

10 • Client: Four works. I'll attend the review without assuming a particular correction has already been approved.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A small chip with an unknown cause

A receptionist arranges a service review for a client.

01 • Receptionist: Which nail concerns you, and what change have you noticed since your visit here?

02 • Client: A small piece of color is missing from the left thumb's edge this morning.

03 • Receptionist: I'll record a chipped coating on that nail and when you first noticed it.

04 • Client: Does that mean you know it was caused by something I did after the appointment?

05 • Receptionist: No. The location and timing don't establish a cause, and I won't assign one.

06 • Client: Good. I'd like someone to examine it before discussing the possible repair or cost.

07 • Receptionist: Tomorrow at noon is a review, not a repair appointment. We'll discuss any work before starting.

08 • Client: Can I keep my other appointment next month? This is a separate concern.

09 • Receptionist: Yes. Booking this review doesn't replace that later appointment unless you ask us to change it.

10 • Client: Then please book noon tomorrow and leave next month's appointment exactly as it stands.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An edge catches on a sleeve

A technician clarifies a client's report without prescribing a home repair.

01 • Technician: Your message says one edge catches on your sleeve. Which finger do you mean?

02 • Client: The right middle finger. I don't know whether the coating is chipped or raised.

03 • Technician: Then let's describe the snag and location without deciding the cause from your message.

04 • Client: Could you tell me how to fix it myself with something I have at home?

05 • Technician: I can't assess the suitable response here. We can arrange a review instead of guessing.

06 • Client: That's fair. I don't want to make the report sound more certain than it is.

07 • Technician: I'll note that you reported catching on fabric, with the exact surface change unconfirmed.

08 • Client: Should I call that lifting when I speak to the person arranging the appointment?

09 • Technician: You can repeat your observation. Lifting is a specific kind of separation we haven't established.

10 • Client: I'll say it catches on my sleeve and ask for the earliest review appointment available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handling a chip or design concern

A client requested line art facing them, but the finished lettering faces away. The service record confirms the client's original direction. A review is available today at four with no review fee. Do not promise a particular correction before assessment.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: lettering direction conflicts with the saved request; can attend the four o'clock review.

Second round: The client interprets a free review as a promise of a free full new set. Clarify what has actually been offered.

Scenario 2 | One missing decorative detail

The agreed design included a white dot on two accent nails; one finished accent nail has no dot. The base color is correct. A technician can review it in twenty minutes.

Role A: Technician: acknowledge the missing detail and offer review.

Role B: Client: want only the missing dot discussed, not the entire design replaced.

Possible opening: This nail has the dot we agreed on, but the other one doesn't.

Success checks

- Correct the inaccurate color description.
- Identify the one missing design element.
- Confirm the review timing without inventing a remedy.

Add a complication: Reception describes the issue as a wrong color.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Scheduling follow-up and handing over exact requests

Distinguish a requested appointment from confirmed service details.

SITUATION

A client requested plain color next Friday at ten but also reports an unidentified existing product. Reception must arrange a consultation before confirming removal time or an infill. The client declines nail art. Friday is a requested time, not yet booked.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

removal appointment - A visit booked to assess and remove an existing nail product using the appropriate professional service.

infill - A maintenance service addressing the grown-out area of an existing enhancement when suitable.

booking deposit - Money paid in advance toward an appointment under the salon's stated terms.

consultation - A discussion to clarify preferences, relevant history, and the proposed nail service before agreement.

Useful word combinations

allow time for removal: include a separate removal requirement in scheduling

confirm the existing product: identify what is already on the nails

carry over a preference: preserve a confirmed choice for the next worker to check

read back the booking: repeat the date, time, service, and unresolved details

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Pass on what remains undecided

3. Notice the language

State the existing product as unknown rather than guessing its identity. Pass the actual next task to the receiving colleague.

The client requested ____; it isn't booked yet.

The existing product is ____.

Please confirm ____ before offering ____.

Compare this wording: Book the usual infill.

Clearer: Please arrange a consultation; the existing product and suitable service are unconfirmed.

The handover preserves the unknown detail instead of choosing a technical service.

4. Check the language

1. Receptionist: Is Friday at ten confirmed?

Technician: No, that's the client's ____ time.

A. missed

B. extended

C. requested

D. completed

2. Client: Does a deposit tell you which product is on my nails?

Receptionist: No, it concerns the ____.

A. optional gratuity

B. advance payment

C. remaining balance

D. cancellation charge

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Friday is a preference, not a booking

A technician hands a scheduling query to reception.

01 • Technician: The client wants plain color next Friday at ten and has declined all nail art.

02 • Receptionist: Is that appointment already confirmed, or do I still need to check the schedule?

03 • Technician: It's only requested. They also have an existing product whose identity is unknown.

04 • Receptionist: Then I shouldn't allocate removal time or describe the visit as an agreed infill yet.

05 • Technician: Correct. Please arrange a consultation to clarify the existing product and proposed service.

06 • Receptionist: Would a receipt help, even if it lists a color name without a product system?

07 • Technician: It may add information, but the color name alone won't settle the product question.

08 • Receptionist: I'll explain that and offer consultation availability before confirming any service duration today.

09 • Technician: Please repeat the final booking details to the client so the requested time isn't mistaken for confirmation.

10 • Receptionist: I will. Friday at ten remains a preference until we've actually agreed an available appointment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An infill request needs its own discussion

Reception clarifies a returning client's maintenance request.

01 • Receptionist: You selected infill online. Are these the enhancements recorded at your last visit?

02 • Client: No, I had them replaced elsewhere while traveling, but I chose the familiar menu word.

03 • Receptionist: Thank you. We need the current service details, not just the name of the last booking.

04 • Client: Does that mean the saved appointment history doesn't identify what is on my nails now?

05 • Receptionist: Exactly. It describes your earlier visit here, not the later work at another salon.

06 • Client: I have their receipt and can ask for the product information before the consultation.

07 • Receptionist: Please bring what you have. The technician will assess the suitable service rather than assume an infill.

08 • Client: Can I keep tomorrow's consultation while that question is open, without promising to have any work?

09 • Receptionist: Yes. Tomorrow at eleven is a consultation; no enhancement maintenance service is confirmed yet.

10 • Client: I'll bring their receipt tomorrow and ask them for the product details before I come.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The deposit terms need a read-back

A receptionist explains a fictional deposit arrangement.

01 • Receptionist: The ten-dollar booking deposit counts toward your service price, rather than adding to it.

02 • Client: So is that an extra ten dollars on top of the service quote I received?

03 • Receptionist: No. Under these stated terms, it counts toward that price rather than adding to it.

04 • Client: Could you show me the terms for changing the date before I pay today?

05 • Receptionist: Certainly. This salon's booking terms explain the change conditions; they aren't the same everywhere.

06 • Client: I see a deadline for changes. Could you confirm the actual date and time for my appointment?

07 • Receptionist: For this booking, the stated change deadline is Wednesday at noon. Your appointment is Friday at ten.

08 • Client: Then I'd need to contact you before Wednesday noon if I want to request a change.

09 • Receptionist: Correct under these terms. Please ask about anything unclear before deciding whether to make the deposit.

10 • Client: I understand the credit and deadline, and can decide whether to book.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Scheduling follow-up and handing over exact requests

A client requested plain color next Friday at ten but also reports an unidentified existing product. Reception must arrange a consultation before confirming removal time or an infill. The client declines nail art. Friday is a requested time, not yet booked.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Receptionist: need to check availability and arrange a consultation; no product identification or infill approval exists.

Second round: The client finds a receipt with only a color name. Explain why the product identity remains open.

Scenario 2 | A removal request is added after booking

A client booked a forty-minute plain-color appointment but now reports an existing product needing assessment for removal. The technician can offer a consultation today; a longer service slot is available Monday, subject to assessment.

Role A: Receptionist: explain why the original slot does not confirm the added service.

Role B: Client: can attend Monday but need the price before agreeing.

Possible opening: Can you just include removal in my original appointment time?

Success checks

- Keep time availability separate from service suitability.
- Preserve the unknown product information.
- Confirm a consultation rather than invent a removal method or price.

Add a complication: The client thinks a longer slot automatically confirms the product is removable by that service.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Clarifying the service and the intended length

Editing example: Are you choosing the color, the added length, or both?

The question lets the client separate independent choices.

Check 1: B - overlay

A: An embellishment adds decoration rather than naming the overall covering.

B: Correct. An overlay covers the natural nail without deliberately adding length.

C: An extension deliberately adds length beyond the natural nail.

D: An infill maintains a grown-out enhancement rather than naming the initial full covering.

Check 2: A - whether you want to keep your length

A: Correct. The indirect question uses normal statement order.

B: Do not invert subject and verb after 'whether' here.

C: 'You' takes 'want,' not 'wants.'

D: Place 'you' before 'want' in this embedded question.

Model response: You've booked an overlay, and you said you want to keep your current short length. The photograph shows added length, so let's separate its color from its shape. Are you asking for the pictured color on your existing length, or do you want extensions?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Comparing shape and practical length

Editing example: This almond sample is longer and more tapered; the squoval sample is shorter with softer corners.

The explanation names observable differences without a universal ranking.

Check 1: A - squoval

A: Correct. Squoval combines a square-like end with softened corners.

B: An almond outline narrows toward a tip.

C: A round outline has a curved end rather than a flatter one.

D: A pointed outline does not have the stated flatter end.

Check 2: D - free edge

A: The nail bed lies beneath the nail plate, not beyond the fingertip.

B: The cuticle is near the nail's base, not its projecting end.

C: The nail plate names the whole hard visible part, not only the projecting edge.

D: Correct. The free edge extends beyond the fingertip.

Model response: The almond sample narrows toward the tip, whereas this short squoval sample has a flatter end with softer corners. Their lengths differ too, so shape alone isn't the comparison. Since you prefer a short result for keyboard work, let's discuss the shorter reference before deciding what suits your nails.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Explaining color, coverage, and finish

Editing example: Sheer concerns visibility through the color; matte concerns shine.

The explanation separates two independent properties.

Check 1: D - sheer

A: Opaque color hides what lies beneath.

B: Metallic describes a metal-like appearance, not transparency.

C: Matte describes low shine, not coverage.

D: Correct. Sheer color allows the underlying nail to show.

Check 2: C - finish

A: Silhouette concerns the outer shape, which the client is not changing.

B: Added length concerns extension beyond the natural nail, not shine.

C: Correct. Finish describes the shiny or low-shine appearance here.

D: Coverage concerns how much of the underlying nail shows.

Model response: Matte describes the low-shine finish, whereas sheer describes how much of your nail remains visible. You want a sheer pink with less shine, not necessarily an opaque color. This swatch is glossy, so it doesn't show both preferences. We still need to discuss the product choice separately.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote

Editing example: The line art is five dollars per nail; two decorated nails add ten dollars.

The unit of price prevents a misleading total.

Check 1: C - per decorated nail

A: The quote does not cover all ten for five.

B: This repeats the misunderstanding rather than correcting it.

C: Correct. The supplied quote charges for each decorated nail.

D: That would make the design a flat appointment fee.

Check 2: B - provided that we limit the line art to two nails

A: 'Unless' reverses the condition: leaving out two designs is what makes the budget possible.

B: Correct. 'Provided that' states the condition that keeps the agreed scope within budget.

C: Including all four would exceed the stated forty-dollar limit.

D: The charge applies per decorated nail, not once per hand.

Model response: The base service is thirty dollars, and the line art is five dollars per nail. Four decorated nails would total fifty, above your forty-dollar limit. Two accent nails would bring the total to forty. Would you prefer those two, or the thirty-dollar base service without the design?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns

Editing example: You've reported tenderness; I can't identify its cause from this conversation.

The revised wording neither minimizes nor invents a diagnosis.

Check 1: B - unassessed

A: Regrowth has not been shown to account for the reported soreness.

B: Correct. No assessment has established the cause of the soreness.

C: Wear is a possible explanation someone might suggest, not an established cause here.

D: Lifting describes separation and has not been established as the cause.

Check 2: A - lifting

A: Correct. Lifting describes separation of the enhancement from the natural nail.

B: Chipping describes a missing piece, not separation of the enhancement itself.

C: Regrowth concerns new growth rather than this described separation.

D: Sheer coverage lets the natural nail show without describing separation.

Model response: I understand you want the nail to look finished for the event. You've reported unexplained tenderness, so let's pause this request and refer the health concern to an appropriate healthcare professional. I can't diagnose its cause. The salon must separately assess whether the cosmetic service is suitable; the referral doesn't guarantee that we'll proceed.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Giving a clear station-readiness update

Editing example: The station is tidy, but the required readiness checks are incomplete.

The update avoids treating appearance as confirmation.

Check 1: A - incomplete

A: Correct. The required checks have not been finished.

B: Completed would contradict the supplied status of the checks.

C: Repeated says they happened again, which has not been stated.

D: Waived means set aside; these checks still remain required.

Check 2: D - disinfectant's specified contact period

A: A reminder time is a scheduling detail.

B: Arrival is unrelated to the disinfectant term.

C: Consultation length is a different use of time.

D: Correct. The term refers to the product's specified period, not conversation.

Model response: Station three is tidy, but its required readiness checks are not complete. Station two has been confirmed ready, so we can offer that space instead. If you prefer station three, I can update you when its status is confirmed, but I don't have a reliable waiting estimate yet.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Handling a chip or design concern

Editing example: The direction differs from the recorded request; let's arrange a review.

The response addresses the actual mismatch without shifting blame.

Check 1: D - orientation

A: Opacity concerns coverage rather than the direction of lettering.

B: Symmetry concerns corresponding shapes, not which way lettering faces.

C: Color intensity concerns visual strength, not the direction of letters.

D: Correct. Orientation describes the direction in which the letters face.

Check 2: C - fee

A: A record can still be kept for a free review.

B: The review is an appointment even without a fee.

C: Correct. The review has no charge.

D: There is an available four o'clock slot.

Model response: Our service note says the lettering should face you, and the current direction doesn't match that request. I'm sorry we missed that detail. We can review it today at four without a review fee. We'll discuss the suitable correction and any terms before you decide, rather than assume a particular remedy.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Scheduling follow-up and handing over exact requests

Editing example: Please arrange a consultation; the existing product and suitable service are unconfirmed.

The handover preserves the unknown detail instead of choosing a technical service.

Check 1: C - requested

A: No confirmed visit has been missed.

B: No appointment has been lengthened.

C: Correct. The client has asked for it, but availability is unconfirmed.

D: A future time cannot be completed.

Check 2: B - advance payment

A: A gratuity is an optional tip, not an appointment deposit.

B: Correct. A booking deposit is payment made in advance under stated terms.

C: The remaining balance is what is still owed after any credited deposit.

D: A cancellation charge concerns changing or missing a booking, not the deposit's definition.

Model response: The client wants plain color next Friday at ten and has declined nail art. They report an existing product but cannot identify it, so removal time and any infill suitability remain unconfirmed. Please arrange a consultation and check availability. Friday at ten is their request, not a confirmed appointment.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All scenarios, prices, products, records, and incidents are fictional language practice. This is not instruction in nail preparation, application, removal, disinfection, chemical handling, or medical assessment. Qualified staff must determine service suitability and follow current product instructions and local requirements. Do not diagnose nail or skin conditions from these exercises.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Manicurists and Pedicurists

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/personal-care-and-service/manicurists-and-pedicurists.htm>

OSHA: Health Hazards in Nail Salons

<https://www.osha.gov/nail-salons>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Nail Technician English

Professional audience: Nail technicians, manicurists, pedicurists, and nail-salon reception staff

Scope: All scenarios, prices, products, records, and incidents are fictional language practice. This is not instruction in nail preparation, application, removal, disinfection, chemical handling, or medical assessment. Qualified staff must determine service suitability and follow current product instructions and local requirements. Do not diagnose nail or skin conditions from these exercises.

Lesson 01: Clarifying the service and the intended length

Original fictional case: A client booked an overlay but calls it a full set and points to a long reference image. They actually want to keep their current short length. No work has begun. Clarify length and explain why the image does not automatically mean extensions.

Language workshop: Check length before interpreting a service label

Communication goal: Distinguish a client's visual preference from a booking name.

Language guidance: Terms such as full set can be used loosely. Ask about added length explicitly rather than treating a photograph as a complete instruction.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Do you want added length or ___? / Which part of the photo do you mean? / Your booking says ___; let's confirm ___.

Vocabulary: manicure: A cosmetic service for fingernails and hands, with the included elements set by the salon menu. / pedicure: A cosmetic service for toenails and feet, not medical treatment of foot conditions. / overlay: An enhancement product applied over the natural nail without deliberately adding length. / extension: An artificial addition that lengthens the nail beyond its natural length.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: want the pictured pink color but no additional length; used full set without a precise meaning.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The client says overlay and extension sound interchangeable. Explain the length distinction plainly.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: You've booked an overlay, and you said you want to keep your current short length. The photograph shows added length, so let's separate its color from its shape. Are you asking for the pictured color on your existing length, or do you want extensions?

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT

Choose a clear message

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: You've booked an overlay, and you said you want to keep your current short length. The photograph shows added length, so let's separate its color from its shape. Are you asking for the pictured color on your existing length, or do you want extensions?

END REFERENCE

TASK: Coach guided workplace message choices

1. Use only the supplied reference and create one short, realistic dialogue with professional role labels and exactly one missing word or phrase. Supply four distinct options labelled A-D. Ensure that exactly one option fits both the grammar and the stated facts. Do not request a draft, an essay, or any open-ended writing. Stop and wait for my choice.
2. Use plausible distractors based on word combinations, certainty, timing, responsibility, or register. Avoid obviously absurd options. Do not introduce an unverified diagnosis, approval, deadline, charge, or legal rule. If extra fictional facts are necessary, state them explicitly before asking the question.
3. After I choose, identify the correct option and explain briefly why each of the other three options does not fit this exchange. Quote the relevant case fact or wording. Invite me to read both roles aloud; do not claim to assess pronunciation from a typed response.
4. Offer another four-choice exchange that practices a different expression. Present only one question at a time, wait for my answer, and vary the correct letter. If more than one answer is defensible, acknowledge the ambiguity and replace the question rather than marking a reasonable choice wrong.
5. After four exchanges, recap two useful word combinations and one distinction I should revisit. Ask which supported scenario I want to rehearse next, then stop and wait.

END PROMPT